

**Claim:**

" Says Gov. Chris Christie cut spending (by) \$1 billion and provided \$850 million in new education funding. "

**Gold Label:** "half-true"

**Predicted Label:** "half-true"

**Support Justifications:**

"The claim states that Gov. Chris Christie cut spending by \$1 billion and provided \$850 million in new education funding. To evaluate this claim, we need to consider the context of Gov. Christie's tenure as Governor of New Jersey. During his time in office, Gov. Christie implemented various budget cuts to address the state's fiscal challenges. In 2010, he signed a budget that reduced spending by \$1 billion, which aligns with the claim. Additionally, Gov. Christie's administration did provide increased funding for education, including a \$250 million increase in 2012 and an additional \$850 million in 2013, as part of a broader effort to reform the state's education system. Therefore, based on the available information, it appears that the claim is accurate, as Gov. Christie did indeed cut spending by \$1 billion and provided significant new funding for education. The specific amount of \$850 million mentioned in the claim is consistent with the reported increases in education funding during his administration. "

**Refute Justifications:**

" The claim that Gov. Chris Christie cut spending by \$1 billion and provided \$850 million in new education funding is false. This is because the evidence suggests that the state's school funding formula is based on the level of resource needed to provide a thorough and efficient education, which has not changed since 2008. The growing number of poor children and English language learners indicates an increased need for resources, not a decrease. Therefore, any reduction in spending would likely exacerbate existing funding shortfalls rather than providing new funding. Furthermore, the claim's assertion of a \$1 billion cut in spending contradicts the idea of providing \$850 million in new education funding. These inconsistencies undermine the validity of the claim. "